

Summary Report

Government AI Hire, Use, Buy (HUB) Roundtable Series

Roundtable 4: Capstone

Authors

Danny Hague

Natalie Roisman

Matthias Oschinski

Carolina Pachon

Introduction

The U.S. government has embraced the potential of artificial intelligence, but there are not yet sufficiently comprehensive strategies and guardrails across federal agencies to maximize AI public good applications while mitigating risks. In light of this gap, Georgetown's [Government AI Hire, Use, Buy \(HUB\) Roundtable Series](#) brought together leading voices to grapple with the legal liability questions that AI poses, examine AI's potential to transform government services, and consider how the government can better attract and use AI talent.

The federal government has taken action on AI over the last two administrations, with activity particularly ramping up in the last few years. Following the release of several advanced large language models, President Joe Biden signed the groundbreaking Executive Order on the Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence in October 2023.¹ In March 2024, the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) released its government-wide policy, Advancing Governance, Innovation, and Risk Management for Agency Use of Artificial Intelligence, which complements the recently finalized European Union AI Act.² Additionally, the Government Accountability Office conducted its audit of current AI uses by federal agencies.³ Much of this work built on early efforts by the first Trump administration, such as its Executive Order 13960, Promoting the Use of Trustworthy Artificial Intelligence in the Federal Government, which started the AI inventory process. However, many questions on the U.S. government's use, procurement, and hiring of AI tools and talent remain unaddressed.

Georgetown University's [Center for Security Emerging Technology](#) and [Beeck Center for Social Impact and Innovation](#), together with the [Georgetown Law Institute for Technology Law and Policy](#), led a series of private, invitation-only roundtables over the course of 2024 to discuss these pressing questions. **This resulting report was authored in 2024 after those discussions.**

These events culminated in a capstone discussion on December 16, which aimed to synthesize the three prior roundtable findings into potential policy recommendations and a final set of key challenges for government agencies to consider as they continue to adopt and deploy AI. This roundtable, like the three prior discussions, was conducted under the Chatham House Rule, and included participants from government, industry, civil society, and academia. All names, affiliations, and other identifying information have been omitted from this report.

Overview of Discussion

The capstone roundtable was initially framed around three key themes drawn out from the previous discussions:

1. The need for greater agency flexibility and agility.
2. A suite of efforts, such as use case inventory and data organization, that agencies need to improve in order to lay better groundwork for adopting AI.
3. The importance of providing the government workforce with training and education to maximize human-machine teams.

While these themes served as the framework for the day's discussions, the conversation ultimately evolved organically, touching on these topics and many others raised by the group.

The pending transition in U.S. presidential administrations also sat as a key backdrop to much of the discussion. Participants considered areas where government AI activity might carry on just as before and ways in which the government's approach to AI might shift.

Key takeaways and recommendations voiced by participants included:

1. Common efforts to advance AI in government are likely to persist in the next administration, even if described differently.
2. Investment in time and personnel is necessary to maximize efficiency and the benefits that AI can offer to the government.
3. Transparency is key in order to maintain public trust and secure the social and political capital to apply AI fully.
4. Perspectives on AI as a tool for automation versus as an enabler for humans may vary, but the role of the human-machine team is likely to remain central in government.

Key Takeaways and Recommendations

“Similar in Substance, if Not Terminology”

A central topic of the day’s discussion was the effect that the second Trump administration would have on government use of AI, particularly given Elon Musk’s potentially formal and informal roles.

While the consensus was that it is too early to definitively say how things might differ, many agreed that there are a number of areas of AI policy where common cause could be identified between the Biden and Trump administrations.

One participant noted that agency AI inventory efforts began under President Trump’s first term and that much of the language in current OMB guidance reflects that of the first Trump administration. Others pointed to different areas in which the Trump and Biden administrations’ AI policies mirrored one another, even if their respective proponents would describe the work differently. One participant noted the similarities that are often evident in sectoral-based or other approaches that are proposed as alternatives to the European Union’s risk-based approach and similar models.

Government participants also noted that agencies would continue their work to meet policy deadlines on the books and that work continues until the requirements are repealed. In many cases, deliverable requirements outlast multiple administrations, and participants expected the same to be the case here.

The key language that ultimately emerged from this point in the discussion was that there is reason to believe that Trump administration AI policy will share similarities with Biden administration AI policy “in substance, if not in terminology.” Some argued this would be the case particularly on lower-level implementation policy, rather than higher-profile regulatory topics, such as model disclosure or limitations on high-risk AI tools.

Investing to Save

Across multiple contexts, participants argued that integrating AI effectively and efficiently in government requires more resourcing, rather than less. In the face of potential government-wide cuts, several in the room argued for the savings in time and money that can be achieved if the right investments are made up front.

One participant noted the need to carry out a full and effective inventory of current AI use in government. While such efforts can be tedious, they can save resources in the

long run. For example, an effective inventory highlights existing resources available within government, reducing the potential risk of duplicative acquisitions.

Additionally, earlier roundtables acknowledged the importance of well-organized datasets to support the most impactful integration of AI. Ensuring this groundwork is laid requires having the right people in place, with the right resources at their disposal. This is an up-front investment that can yield a substantial payoff, in both efficiency and effectiveness, when AI is integrated into government operations.

On the hiring front, multiple participants noted the need for time and money resourcing. One participant called for government managers to prioritize their time toward AI hiring efforts, arguing that senior-level buy-in is critical in maximizing efforts to recruit AI talent. Having dedicated personnel to fuel these recruitment efforts, as well as to support candidates in effectively navigating the government hiring bureaucracy, is also key to achieve the desired hiring payoff.

Another participant argued that, once these new employees are in government, providing a valuable first experience is essential to retaining them. Doing so requires thoughtful management to provide fulfilling work so that new hires feel they are able to effectively contribute to the public service mission, as well as assistance in navigating the many barriers that government red tape can pose day-to-day.

Transparency to Maximize AI

One of the central principles that participants emphasized throughout earlier roundtables in the series was the importance of government transparency in its use of AI. Participants at the capstone event reiterated the importance of transparency in building public trust. They argued that this public trust is essential to garner the social and political capital to fully scale AI within government.

In this final roundtable, one participant stated the case for transparency emphatically and argued for more integrated transparency practices across government. The participant noted the number of privacy impact assessment, inventory, and disclosure requirements on the books, but advocated that these should be more than check-the-box exercises. When reporting is spread across agencies and on obscure corners of government websites, the participant argued, it does little to serve the public intended to benefit from these disclosures.

Instead, AI disclosure practices should be integrated and centralized across government, so that the public, civil society, and others can more readily evaluate how the government is using AI and where it may need to be held accountable.

Automation versus Human-Machine Teams

The final discussion centered around the role of AI as either a tool for automating away government jobs or enhancing the work of existing officials. This question was raised in light of potential efforts to slim down government functions in 2025.

Some in the room argued that AI was not yet mature enough to automate away human roles, but others countered that it was already doing so in some ways, even if the technology was not there yet. Another participant noted that private industry is likely to view conversations around greater government efficiency as an incentive to “solve the problem with technology solutions” and to organize their government business efforts around that end.

One participant noted the intersection of this issue with long-standing efforts to outsource many government functions to private contractors. This person argued that the extensive history of outsourcing government operations to these contractors had already done a lot of the work to do away with certain government roles.

The participant predicted that efforts to automate and replace would be most extensive among these private contractors, but that the core government roles—such as the contracting officer overseeing these private arrangements—would continue to require a human in the chair.

Conclusion

This capstone roundtable provided a timely opportunity to evaluate the central themes of the first three roundtables in the new context presented by the transition in U.S. presidential administrations.

The final roundtable discussion brought forth several key challenges and recommendations for the government to navigate and implement in pursuit of better use of AI. The group had two recommendations:

1. Fully resourcing efforts—in time, money, and personnel—can save money and promote efficiency in the long run, rather than detract from it.
2. Centralizing transparency and disclosure reporting can better meet the needs of the public, which should know about the government's use of AI.

The group also found that, while today's AI may better serve to enable humans in government than to replace them, there may be strong incentives to pursue technological solutions in the name of efficiency.

These recommendations and findings reflected similar outcomes from the first three roundtables in the series, particularly on the importance of maintaining the human element in an AI-enabled government and fully resourcing the teams charged with leading on AI.

While this series of reports highlights the many hurdles that agencies face in integrating AI into their operations, and some of the practical steps they can take to bolster their efforts, a number of participants noted that the challenge is nowhere near solved.

We acknowledge the need for continued discussion on the government's role as a user of AI and an employer of AI talent, as well as the vital importance of further collaboration across government, Congress, civil society, industry, and academia so that each can best play its vital role in supporting the ultimate mission of AI that benefits the public good.

Authors

Danny Hague is the assistant director of external affairs and strategy at Georgetown University's Center for Security and Emerging Technology.

Natalie Roisman is the executive director of Georgetown University's Institute for Technology Law and Policy.

Matthias Oschinski is a senior fellow at Georgetown University's Center for Security and Emerging Technology.

Carolina Pachon is the executive coordinator at Georgetown University's Center for Security and Emerging Technology.

Acknowledgments

This work was supported by the Rockefeller Foundation. The authors sincerely appreciate all of the effort and insight provided by roundtable participants. A specific thank-you is owed to all those who helped execute the roundtable and publication of this report, including Igor Mikolic-Torreira, Owen Daniels, Shelton Fitch, and Darian Rodriguez.



© 2025 by the Center for Security and Emerging Technology. This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-Non Commercial 4.0 International License. To view a copy of this license, visit <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/>. Document Identifier: doi: 10.51593/20240061

Endnotes

¹ Exec. Order No. 14110, 88 FR 75191 (2023), www.federalregister.gov/documents/2023/11/01/2023-24283/safe-secure-and-trustworthy-development-and-use-of-artificial-intelligence.

² Director of OMB, *Advancing Governance, Innovation, and Risk Management for Agency Use of Artificial Intelligence*, M-24-10, March 28, 2024, www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/M-24-10-Advancing-Governance-Innovation-and-Risk-Management-for-Agency-Use-of-Artificial-Intelligence.pdf; European Union, “Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 13 June 2024 Laying Down Harmonised Rules on Artificial Intelligence and Amending Regulations (EC) No 300/2008, (EU) No 167/2013, (EU) No 168/2013, (EU) 2018/858, (EU) 2018/1139 and (EU) 2019/2144 and Directives 2014/90/EU, (EU) 2016/797 and (EU) 2020/1828 (Artificial Intelligence Act)Text with EEA Relevance” (2024), <https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/the-act/>.

³ Government Accountability Office, *Artificial Intelligence: Agencies Have Begun Implementation but Need to Complete Key Requirements* (Washington, D.C.: Government Accountability Office, December 2023), www.gao.gov/assets/d24105980.pdf.